

background prove an interesting combination as they keep throwing ideas for discussion. "India has had a long history of culture and education. Let's not forget we produce some of the brightest minds in the world," says Tiwari.

Though IIM Mumbai has become a reality, the folks here are not about to rest on their laurels. The institute has announced an investment of ₹800 crore just to enhance its campus. It is looking to modernise and develop state-of-the-art facilities—all this, just within a year of being rechristened. "Yes, we are India-centric but also want to be a global *gurukul*," Tiwari adds. There are 1,200 students across various programmes and the target is clear: creating skilled professionals in diverse functional areas like operations management, analytics, finance, marketing, project management, HR, information technology, and sustainability management. There is literally enough room on campus to accommodate this expansion. Shetty says there is enough FSI (floor space index, or the ratio of a building's built-up area to the area of the plot that it occupies), meaning there is no need to cut any trees.

After the ₹800-crore investment, the institute issued a veritable statement of intent. "The forthcoming facilities will include a sprawling net-zero campus of the future with world-class residential accommodation for faculty and students, start-up ecosystem development, management development programmes and a large auditorium," it said. And if you think IIM Mumbai will be all about legacy businesses, then you are mistaken. The plan also includes an innovation centre focussed on banking, finance, and fintech, an artificial intelligence-based research hub, and a state-

of-the-art library connecting students with global resources.

The plan is to host a prominent management training centre, offering certification courses, even undergraduate programmes, and serve as a focal point for industry leaders.

MAXIMUM BENEFIT

Of course, this new IIM is born with a huge advantage thanks to its location in the financial capital

or wealth management, the BFSI space is inextricably linked to the city. The institute has partnered with Motilal Oswal Financial Services for financial research and to give its students a collaborative curriculum that it hopes will provide them a competitive advantage.

"Then we have the large corporations and industrial groups which become easily accessible," adds Tiwari. He insists that institutes that are not located in the city may not have such easy access.

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of the country. Acknowledging that, Tiwari says the institute is "uniquely positioned" by just being in Mumbai.

"You just have to look at how much can be done on industry participation. That alone puts us in a position of strength," he says. According to Shetty, while there are some very good business schools in Mumbai, the demand for more high-quality talent exists, and that will always be the case. "There is an opportunity to cater to sectors such as entertainment and sports. These are areas that interest today's business school graduates, and we must capitalise on that."

If one looks at the world of, say, finance, Mumbai throws up many options. Be it investment banking, insurance, equity research,

Is there pressure that comes with the new name just in terms of having to meet very high expectations? Not for Tiwari, on the back of a creditable NIRF ranking.

"The plan is to get the best out of Mumbai. There is industry, capital, and leadership in the city, making it a very unique proposition," he says.

Starting an institute from scratch has its challenges, but IIM Mumbai's journey is really about creating a new brand that has to be much, much stronger than what has been created.

"There are a lot of invisible advantages at our disposal, and we must work towards harnessing them," Tiwari says. **BT**

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